

SHAY BYRNE

www.linkedin.com/in/shaybyrne | <https://www.shaybyrne.work>

CIO / CTO | ENTERPRISE TECHNOLOGY EXECUTIVE | DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION & CLOUD STRATEGY LEADER

Global IT executive with 25+ years of experience leading enterprise-scale digital transformation, cloud strategy, and operational excellence across Microsoft, Intel, and growth-stage ventures. Known for aligning technology to business outcomes, building high-performing teams, and driving modernization at scale.

KEY STRENGTHS & IMPACT

- **Business-Aligned IT Strategy:** Led initiatives with budgets exceeding \$200M, including transformation of Microsoft Canada HQ and multiple regional offices, delivering scalable infrastructure and cutting-edge employee and customer experiences.
- **Transformation & Innovation:** Directed enterprise cloud migration, smart building deployments, and automation projects driving measurable ROI, cost reduction, and employee productivity.
- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Built high-performing, cross-functional global teams with a focus on development, resilience, and continuous improvement.
- **Customer Experience Focus:** Engineered solutions that elevated end-user satisfaction through data insights, agile delivery, and streamlined services.
- **Cybersecurity & Compliance:** Oversaw enterprise-level cybersecurity strategies aligned with evolving threat landscapes and compliance frameworks.

EXECUTIVE EXPERIENCE

CUBICFARMS SYSTEMS CORP., Toronto, ON

April 2022 - Current

Chief Information and Technology Officer (CIO and CTO)

February 2024

Promoted to executive leadership, reporting to the Board of Directors, with full accountability over enterprise technology, engineering, project delivery, IT operations, and cybersecurity, as well as operational strategy and execution.

- Developed enterprise technology and operations strategy to support scale-up of vertical farming systems and commercial deployments.
- Oversaw internal systems and infrastructure for both corporate and field operations, leveraging Microsoft Azure and M365 to ensure secure and reliable access.
- Strengthened alignment between technology roadmap and revenue-generating activities, including engineering support for customer solutions.
- Acted as executive sponsor for customer implementations, coordinating cross-functional delivery and post-sale support alignment.

Vice President of Technology and Operations

January 2023 – February 2024

- Led internal technology audit and restructuring program, resulting in a 35% OPEX reduction via vendor consolidation and contract renegotiation.
- Directed engineering and IT teams with a focus on Azure and Microsoft 365 automation, compliance, and service integration.
- Drove enterprise architecture planning and governance to align systems with internal and external product development needs.

Director of Technology and Operations

April 2022 to December 2022

- Implemented extensive automation of Microsoft Cloud services including M365, Intune, Teams, SharePoint, and Azure Active Directory.
- Integrated PowerApps and workflow automation to reduce manual support load and improve internal responsiveness and employee onboarding and offboarding.
- Led infrastructure upgrades across office and production spaces to support secure connectivity, remote access, and internal service enhancements.

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MICROSOFT CANADA INC., Toronto, ON
Principal Regional IT Director

2012 – 2022
2016 – February 2022

Led national IT operations and customer experience transformation initiatives across Microsoft Canada, blending internal service excellence with external executive engagement. Directed large-scale real estate and infrastructure programs and served as a national spokesperson for Microsoft Digital's vision. Partnered with global and local stakeholders to implement flagship workplace innovations and showcase modern IT solutions to enterprise audiences.

- Managed national IT operations across 10 campuses, overseeing network, helpdesk, AV, digital signage, Microsoft Technology Centers, and vendor relationships supporting 2000+ staff.
- Oversaw delivery of seven real estate projects including Microsoft Canada HQ, integrating smart building controls, AV experiences, flexible workspaces, and Zero Trust architecture.
- Served as a Microsoft Digital Customer Showcase Lead, delivering over 40 executive briefings to CxO audiences on topics such as modern workplace, cloud transformation, and smart infrastructure.

Global Account Technology Strategist

2012 – 2016

Led technical sales strategy and solution architecture for Microsoft's largest Canadian financial services clients. Partnered closely with global account teams, C-level stakeholders, and engineering leads delivering cloud transformation, infrastructure modernization, and enterprise licensing strategy.

- Directed the technical strategy for top-tier financial clients (TD, BMO), delivering Microsoft 365, Azure, and Identity solutions across hundreds of thousands of endpoints.
- Spearheaded Microsoft 365 E5 deployment at TD Bank for 96K mailboxes and led Azure MFA adoption at BMO for enterprise identity access.
- Eliminated reliance on Windows XP at major Canadian banks, facilitating compliance and modernization through coordinated OS migration projects.
- Consistently exceeded sales targets, contributing to \$100M+ in Microsoft enterprise licensing revenue.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

SPECOPS SOFTWARE, Toronto, ON; **Director of IT, Technical Evangelist**

2009-2012

- Represented Specops Software at enterprise trade shows, delivering over 20 speaking engagements on desktop management and deployment.
- Drove product development cycles for Specops Deploy, Inventory and Password; led technical sales and customer solutioning across North America.

CMS CONSULTING, Toronto, ON; **Senior Manageability Infrastructure Consultant**

2008-2009

- Designed and deployed System Center solutions for healthcare, finance, and government clients.
- Delivered infrastructure for patching, deployment, and compliance using SCCM, OpsMgr, App-V, and MDOP.

IT Consultant / Infrastructure Architect, Celbridge, Ireland (Freelance)

2007-2008

- Delivered Active Directory and System Center migrations for large clients in finance and manufacturing sectors.

INTEL CORPORATION, Leixlip, Ireland; **Senior Systems and Manageability Product Architect**

1992-2007

- Led Intel's global implementation, design, and validation of System Center Operations Manager (SCOM) via Microsoft's TAP program to ensure alignment with large-scale enterprise monitoring needs.
- Architected a secure, scalable global manageability infrastructure using SCOM to enable availability monitoring, fault detection, service health reporting, and real-time telemetry across more than 500,000 client and server systems.
- Developed custom dashboards and tooling to deliver actionable insights on system uptime, fault trends, and performance metrics, enhancing operational visibility and reliability for global IT operations.

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EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- **Bachelor of Arts (BA)**, Technology Management, Institute of Technology, Tallaght, Ireland
- Certificate in Electronic Engineering, Regional Technical College, Dundalk, Ireland
- Certificate in Computer-Aided Design, Electronics and Engineering Applications, Senior College, Ballyfermot, Ireland

CERTIFICATIONS

- MS-900 Microsoft (MS) 365 Fundamentals
- Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer: (MCSE)
- MCITP: - Enterprise Administrator
- Microsoft Certified Technology Specialist: (MCTS)

TECHNOLOGY & PLATFORMS

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365, Intune, Endpoint Manager, Active Directory, System Center
- **Tools & Services:** PowerApps, Teams, Exchange, SharePoint, PowerShell, Group Policy, Specops, App-V, MDT, Docker
- **Security & Compliance:** Azure AD, MFA, Conditional Access, Zero Trust, Endpoint Protection
- **Languages & Scripting:** PowerShell, Python, YAML, Jinja